

V08 PHYSICAL ACTIVITY SPACES AND EQUIPMENT | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Promote physical activity and exercise by providing access to physical activity spaces and equipment at no cost.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide access to a physical activity space at no cost through an on-site fitness facility, nearby facility or nearby outdoor spaces, such as a park.

Issue : International physical activity guidelines recommend both cardiovascular and muscle strengthening activities for the general population.¹ Despite widely disseminated guidelines, nearly a quarter of the general population fails to achieve recommended physical activity levels.² Key determinants of physical activity behavior include time, convenience, motivation, self-efficacy, weather conditions, travel and family obligations, fear of injury and lack of social support.^{3,4} At a community scale, additional environmental barriers exist, such as availability of sidewalks, parks and bicycle lanes.^{3,4}

Solutions : In a systematic review conducted by the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, creating enhanced places for physical activity increased engagement and biomarkers for physical fitness, including aerobic capacity and energy expenditure, with a few studies documenting some decrease in body weight and body fat.⁵ Creating space within a building for physical activity is important, along with larger efforts to design communities to encourage movement. Factors such as proximity and quality of parks are important predictors of physical activity, although more consistent research is needed.^{6,7}

PART 1 PROVIDE INDOOR ACTIVITY SPACES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Option 1: On-site physical activity spaces

A dedicated fitness facility is available within the project boundary at no cost to regular occupants and is sized according to one of the following requirements:

- a. The space includes at least two types of exercise or sporting equipment (e.g., free weights, treadmill, yoga mat, basketball) in quantities that allow use by at least 5% of regular occupants at any time.⁸
- b. The space includes at least two types of exercise or sporting equipment (e.g., free weights, treadmill, yoga mat, basketball). The minimum size is 25m² plus 0.1 m² per regular occupant or 930 m², whichever is smaller.⁹

OR

Option 2: Off-site physical activity spaces

The project meets the following requirement:

- a. Regular occupants have access to a fitness facility at no cost within a 200 m walking distance of the project boundary.

PART 2 PROVIDE OUTDOOR PHYSICAL ACTIVITY SPACE (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one of the following outdoor physical activity spaces is within a 400 m walk distance of the project boundary and available at no cost to regular occupants:

- a. Green space (e.g., park, walking/biking trail).
- b. Blue space (e.g., swimming area).
- c. Recreational field or court.
- d. Fitness zone that includes all-weather fitness equipment.
- e. For projects with child occupants, play space geared toward children (e.g., playground).

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